

Snippets

Fujitsu to make e-books

Fujitsu will partner with Dai Nippon Printing to make e-books. This will be one-of-a-kind e-book service with cross-platform integration that would let a wide variety of e-book publishers to submit their work. Fujitsu plans to go live this May with more than 300,000 titles.

HTC to hire 3000 by 2012

At the inauguration of its new facility in Chennai, HTC Global Services announced plans to recruit nearly 3000 people by the end of March 2012. "The market has picked up, and we need to be ready with the right people," said Madhava Reddy, president and CEO, HTC Global. The company had invested close to Rs 3 billion on infrastructure expansion in the last one year alone.

sion, infrastructure development and employment generation. According to ELCINA, a similar push is needed for the electronics manufacturing sector to bridge the huge demand-supply gap of over \$25 billion.

ELCINA had expected a policy statement to this effect, but the budget is totally silent on the subject. The association wants the government to lay emphasis on making electronics manufacturing clusters a reality with its participation. The Special Incentive Package, which is under preparation, should be implemented as soon as possible and must include all the electronics manufacturing segments, including components, parts, semi-conductors, sub-assemblies and final products.

Govt to extend preferential status to indigenous products

To reduce the widening trade deficit created by imports, the government may extend preferential status to 'made in India' products in the New Telecom Policy 2011.

"Broader telecom policy will include measures appropriate to encourage domestic telecom manufacturing. Some aspects have been considered by the committee of secretaries, and preferential status for domestic manufacturers is one of them," said R. Chandrashekar, secretary, Department of Telecom (DoT).

Estimates show that India's demand for electronics products (including telecom) will be \$400 billion by 2020. Meanwhile, at the existing rate



T-Mobile SIM card

of growth, the electronics hardware production is likely to grow to \$104 billion by 2020, creating a demand and supply gap of \$296 billion which would have to be met through imports. In the wake of the rising import bill of IT and telecom products, it has become all the more important for the centre to develop an eco-system for boosting indigenous manufacturing in the country.

Fibre optics to link Indian educational institutions

In order to create a free information highway, Union Minister for HRD and IT Kapil Sibal has opined to link 800 universities and 26,000 colleges in India through a fibre-optic network.

While speaking at a function, Sibal said that it was needed to converge technologies to provide interactive modules on TV screens so that anyone could access them. He also suggested that free flow of information and knowledge could help to develop self-testing modules

and self-appraisal procedures.

Sibal emphasised the need for innovation in order to take education to all sections.

Imported SIM cards under scrutiny

The newly constituted high-level committee of central security agencies and telecom department is set to carry out a joint technical assessment of imported SIM cards in view of the security threat posed by them. Telecom operators may have

to absorb the replacement cost of all such SIM cards. Security agencies fear that SIM being a mini computer, malware programs can be embedded in them to track and monitor the telephone activity of the users.

Nearly 70 per cent of SIM cards are manufactured in India, while over 30 per cent are imported.

One million UID cards every day

While presenting the Union Budget for 2011-12, Indian Finance minister Pranab Mukherjee laid special emphasis on improving the governance through the unique identification (UID) project—now known as 'Aadhaar.'

From October this year, the government plans to generate one million 'Aadhaar' (UID) numbers everyday for citizens across the country to improve service delivery. Mukherjee said that the UID Mission has taken off and Aadhaar numbers are being generated in large numbers. The government has so far distributed about two million Aadhaar numbers.

Govt to get Rs 300 billion from telecom

Indicating another round of spectrum auction, the Indian government expects to get nearly Rs 300 billion from telecom services in 2011-12. This includes revenues from licence fee